

Chemical curiosities

Antoine's experiments showed that nothing is created or destroyed during a chemical reaction. Things are just shuffled around and changed into different forms. This is known as the "law of conservation of mass." His experiments also showed that air and water are not elements, as the ancient Greeks had believed.

Air is a mixture of different gases, including oxygen.

Water is a compound—a substance made up of two building blocks: oxygen and hydrogen. Antoine's work ignited a revolution in chemistry and a race to find new elements. It also guided other chemists in how to study the world, based on careful experiments and observations.

Antoine referred to his early list of elements as "simple substances."

Antoine made one of the first lists of elements—substances that cannot be broken apart into simpler parts.

Noms nouveaux.	Noms anciens correspondans.
Lumière.....	Lumière.
Chaleur.....	Chaleur.
Calorique.....	Principe de la chaleur.
Feu.....	Feu.
Matière du feu & de la chaleur.	Matière du feu & de la chaleur.
Air déphlogistiqué.....	Air déphlogistiqué.
Air empiété.....	Air empiété.
Air vital.....	Air vital.
Baie de l'air vital.....	Baie de l'air vital.
Gas phlogistique.....	Gas phlogistique.
Acide.....	Acide.
Baie de la mofette.....	Baie de la mofette.
Gas inflammable.....	Gas inflammable.
Baie du gas inflammable.....	Baie du gas inflammable.
Soufre.....	Soufre.
Phosphore.....	Phosphore.
Charbon pur.....	Charbon pur.
Inconnu.....	Inconnu.
Radical fluorique.....	Radical fluorique.
Radical muriatique.....	Radical muriatique.
Radical boracique.....	Radical boracique.
Antimoine.....	Antimoine.
Argent.....	Argent.
Arénie.....	Arénie.
Bismuth.....	Bismuth.
Cobalt.....	Cobalt.
Cuivre.....	Cuivre.
Étain.....	Étain.
Enfer.....	Enfer.
Manganèse.....	Manganèse.
Mercur.....	Mercur.
Molybdène.....	Molybdène.
Nickel.....	Nickel.
Or.....	Or.
Platine.....	Platine.
Plomb.....	Plomb.
Tungstène.....	Tungstène.
Zinc.....	Zinc.
Chaux.....	Terre calcaire, chaux.
Magnésie.....	Magnésie, base du sel d'Epsom.
Barye.....	Barye, terre pesante.
Argile.....	Argile, terre de lalan, baie de lalan.
Alumine.....	Alumine.
Silice.....	Terre siliceuse, terre vitrifiable.



As a wealthy former official, Antoine was arrested during the French Revolution, when the French political system was overthrown. He was then executed by guillotine—a device built to chop off a person's head.

